



Security Watch

JPEG Vulnerability

The Problem

Unpatched Windows PCs are vulnerable to attacks by innocuous image files. Pictures in the JPEG format can be embedded with a malware application, which eventually launches an attack on a Windows system. The vulnerability is present in at least a dozen Microsoft software applications, such as Windows XP, Windows Server 2003, Office XP, Office 2003, Internet Explorer 6 Service Pack 1, etc. Only Windows XP Service Pack 2 is not vulnerable to the flaw.

Damages

PCs using the affected software are in immediate threat. In fact, security software company McAfee puts the potential for attack at "very high".

Precautions

Microsoft has created a separate tool to deliver the patches to its software. The company has issued a bulletin on at http://www.microsoft.com/security/bulletins/200409_jpeg.msp. The tool will scan your computer for affected software and will subsequently download the necessary patches. Even if you have deployed Service Pack 2, other software, such as MS Office, will still be vulnerable to the attacks. Microsoft recommends running the Office update to tackle this threat.

LCD MONITORS

The Big Picture

Bigger is definitely better when it comes to PC monitors and television screens. And when perks include saving nearly 75 per



cent desk space, less eye-strain due to zero radiation and oodles of style, LCDs beat CRTs hollow.

TFT LCD (Thin Film Transistor Liquid Crystal Display) monitors are making their presence felt in the Indian market over the past year.

With about 40,000 units sold in India, in the third quarter of 2003, research firm IDC predicted a 5.8 per cent market share for LCDs in 2004. Yet, CRT monitors rule the roost in the home and SoHo segment, primarily because of the cost-factor.

Says R Manikandan, LG

India's Deputy GM (Sales and Marketing), IT Products: "LCDs will never replace CRT monitors in a price-sensitive market such as India. Since CRTs are available at half the cost, it will take a long time for the latter to make inroads into the home segment."

Pure View Technologies, which has collaborated with Taiwan-based Funet, plans to woo the Indian market by offering LCDs at rates that are 20 per cent lower than the big brands. With factories in Sri Lanka, Pure View has taken advantage of the Free Trade Agreement between India and Sri Lanka.

Dhananjay Shah, Director, Pure View, predicts that LCDs will replace CRTs in India, in a little over two years. "Timing is key," he says, pointing out that LCD prices are likely to fall towards the middle of next year. "This is primarily because the technology is evolving and with newer

"LCD monitors will never replace CRT monitors in India"
-R Manikandan, LG Electronics

products (read: plasma displays) entering the market, LCD prices will be slashed."

Apart from niche companies such as Pure View and UMAX, Sony, Philips, Samsung, and LG have also entered the LCD race in India.

As of now, hospitals, banks, and other corporates have stepped onto the LCD bandwagon. Pure View has

HOT



IBM

IBM is developing an entirely new type of anti-spam software. The research draws upon ideas from programs that find DNA sequences

NOT

The US of A

The US is still Number 1 in the dubious list of countries that generate the most spam. It was responsible for 43 per cent of all spam sent in August 2004



also joined forces with channel partners to offer buy-back schemes on CRTs to customers. "Corporates may upgrade to LCDs where work involves long hours of computer usage," says Manikandan.

LCDs are currently available in sizes ranging from 13 to 20 inches, while plasma display sizes range from 32 to 60 inches.

The LCD revolution has begun. But is India ready for the makeover?

SEARCH ENGINES

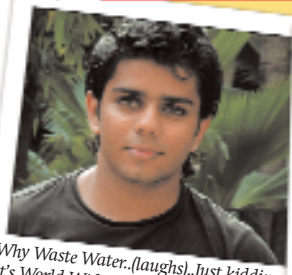
War As Usual

With the advances in search technologies, how do we know which search engine is better?

We started with a traditional search query:



One Silly Question What is WWW?



Why Waste Water..(laughs)..Just kidding, it's World Wide Web, a network of sites
Ryan 'Panther' Mendosa, Mumbai



World Wide Web. Great for research. Gives you whatever you're looking for
Sowmya Katathil, Pune



World Wide Web. It connects people all over the world. That's how it got its name
Suraj Wanvari, Mumbai



It's World Wide Web. That's it? This is a network of Web sites
Akai Ayemi, Dimapur



I don't know. It's the opening gate for the layman; makes surfing easy
Tusharr Tarun, Mumbai